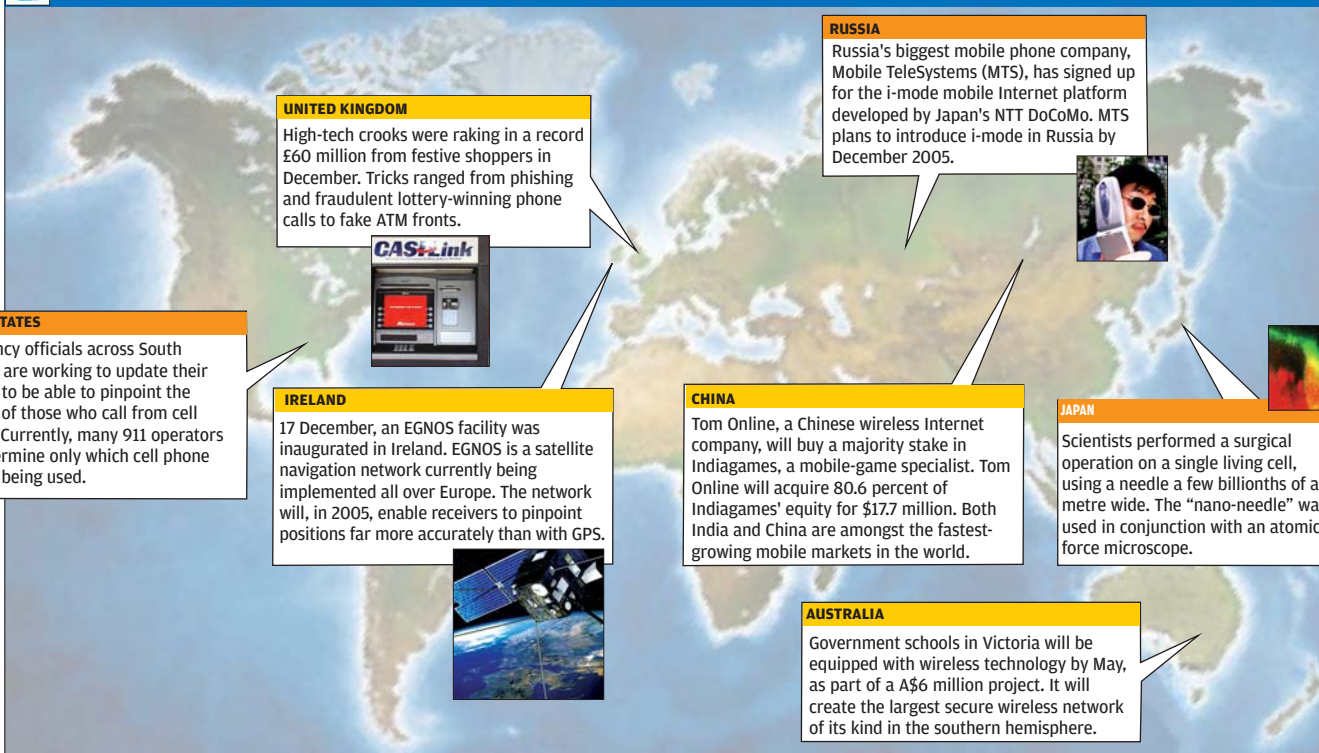


 The Digital World

A Round-up of Technology News from Across the Globe



UNITED KINGDOM
High-tech crooks were raking in a record £60 million from festive shoppers in December. Tricks ranged from phishing and fraudulent lottery-winning phone calls to fake ATM fronts.

UNITED STATES
Emergency officials across South Carolina are working to update their systems to be able to pinpoint the location of those who call from cell phones. Currently, many 911 operators can determine only which cell phone tower is being used.

IRELAND
17 December, an EGNOS facility was inaugurated in Ireland. EGNOS is a satellite navigation network currently being implemented all over Europe. The network will, in 2005, enable receivers to pinpoint positions far more accurately than with GPS.

RUSSIA
Russia's biggest mobile phone company, Mobile TeleSystems (MTS), has signed up for the i-mode mobile Internet platform developed by Japan's NTT DoCoMo. MTS plans to introduce i-mode in Russia by December 2005.

CHINA
Tom Online, a Chinese wireless Internet company, will buy a majority stake in Indiagames, a mobile-game specialist. Tom Online will acquire 80.6 percent of Indiagames' equity for \$17.7 million. Both India and China are amongst the fastest-growing mobile markets in the world.

JAPAN
Scientists performed a surgical operation on a single living cell, using a needle a few billionths of a metre wide. The "nano-needle" was used in conjunction with an atomic force microscope.

AUSTRALIA
Government schools in Victoria will be equipped with wireless technology by May, as part of a A\$6 million project. It will create the largest secure wireless network of its kind in the southern hemisphere.

THEY'VE COME A LONG WAY

Intel Inside, But AMD Knocking On The Door

Advanced Micro Devices (AMD) Inc has come a long way from being a low-cost supplier of Intel chip clones to supplying premium parts. According to market research firm International Data Corporation (IDC), AMD took hold of nearly 10 per cent of the CPU market with its Athlon 64 and Opteron range, compared with an earlier 8.5 percent. AMD's average chip price also rose by 10 per cent. The company raised its market share in server chips from 6.9 per cent to 8 per cent, and has 18.4 per cent of the desktop and 9.3 per cent of the notebook markets.

Low-cost product offerings by AMD have been well accepted in the emerging markets of India, China and in Eastern

Europe. Also, Dell's decision to withdraw from the Chinese market was in a way related to the popularity of local brands powered by AMD processors.

An IDC analyst added that AMD's strategy of manufacturing server chips and PCs employed by video game enthusiasts assisted its market growth. In mid-December, AMD and IBM improved a chip-making technology called "strained silicon," which boosted semiconductor performance.

Though Intel commands 81.2 percent of the market share, AMD is expected to surpass Intel by 2017.

INTELLIGENT MUSIC DEVICE

What You Want, When You Want

Recently launched by an Indian musical instruments company, "uMusic" or "Intelligent Music" is a revolution in home entertainment systems, and promises to



Three Incredibly Useful Sites

Quizzes, Trivia, And The Like

www.coolquiz.com/quizzes/



Cool Quiz!

Coolquiz.com's site layout is a bit disorganised, but there's lots of fun quizzes here, in various categories. Take your pick—a random quiz, a daily-updated pop quiz, a "Totally Tuff" quiz where you "WILL" learn something, and so on. The site boasts of a total of over 35,000 trivia questions.

www.funtrivia.com



Fun Trivia.com

"From Harry Potter to Particle Physics ... and EVERYTHING in between!" That's what funtrivia.com says about itself—with more than 658,000 questions online. The categories are innumerable. Quizzes are organised not only topic-wise, but also by difficulty. A must-visit.

www.queendom.com/mindgames/quizdom/



Trivia Quizdom

This site boasts of a total of 178 categories. The categories, of course, span all interests, the features ones being "science," "society and culture," "people", and so on. In addition to quizzes, there are also interactive tests, mind games, polls and surveys, and more.